World Health Organization
African Region

Decision follow-up and Regional Office support standard

Paper MEC-09, policy P6 of 7, for decision

Friday 20 November 2026, 11:20–12:35 | Block C. Use evidence for decisions | For decision

Draft of 4 November 2026 for TWG review. Parameters such as deadlines, response times and thresholds not set by the Framework are proposals, shown as such in the decision options.

The policy in brief

Every decision records its evidence, root cause, owner, deadline and how completion will be verified; actions close only with verification; overdue actions are escalated; lessons are recorded and shared; Regional Office support requests are acknowledged within 5 working days and answered with an agreed plan within 20.

Why this policy

Decision-making is where performance is actually managed. The Framework's accountability loop requires decisions to be documented, turned into owned actions and verified against evidence, with a defined path upwards for issues an office cannot resolve: from the country review to the MEC, and from the MEC to the Regional Programme Meeting.

The 2026 decision log shows the loop is open at almost every point, and that Country Offices asking the Regional Office for help have no assurance of when or how they will receive it.

What the evidence shows

- **970** decisions logged in SAM1 2026 (800 unique); **none** records a root cause; **91** were overdue at export and **3** had been approved.
- **84** decisions need Regional Office support, from 19 Country Offices; 11 of them were already overdue, and no response standard exists.
- **13** decisions were escalated, to four different levels, with no defined pathway.
- The SAM1 Learning Hub holds **356** entries from 2026, of which **1** was flagged for regional sharing.

Scope

The decision logs and action trackers of the 47 Country Offices and the six Regional Office budget centres, and all support requested by Country Offices from the Regional Office.

The policy

1. **What a decision records.** As the Framework requires, each decision in the log records the evidence that prompted it, the decision, its owner by role and its deadline (Annex E; Annex G, Module 7). This policy adds three fields: the root cause, the expected effect and how completion will be verified. The SAM1 log already has a root-cause field; it is empty in all 970 entries. One decision may cover several P/S; duplicates are merged.
2. **Root cause for serious and recurring problems.** For decisions rated high or critical, and for problems that recur across several P/S, the root cause is established with a structured method such as the five whys, the technique Annex B, Section B5, applies to capability gaps.
3. **Owned actions.** Each decision gives rise to one or more actions in the action tracker, each with an owner and a deadline.
4. **Verification before closure.** An action is closed only when its completion and effect are confirmed against evidence by someone other than its owner, normally the MEAL focal point, following the verification protocol (Annex J). Until Annex J is issued, MSC issues a one-page verification protocol by 31 January 2027.
5. **Monthly follow-up.** Open and overdue actions are reviewed at every monthly WR-led review.

6. **Escalation path.** As the Framework sets out, issues an office cannot resolve go from the country review to the MEC, and from the MEC to the Regional Programme Meeting where warranted (Part XI.2). This policy adds two steps: an action overdue by more than 30 days, or a decision beyond the office's authority, first goes to the responsible Regional Office cluster for support; and between MEC sessions, the DPM handles escalated issues on the MEC's behalf and reports them at its next session.
7. **Regional Office support standard.** Country Offices record support requests in the decision log, with the Regional Office as the support required. The responsible cluster acknowledges each request within 5 working days, names a focal person and agrees an action plan with the office within 20 working days. A request that cannot be met is answered with the reason and an alternative. MSC reports response times to the DPM each quarter and to the MEC each year.
8. **Learning from follow-through.** Each quarter, the WR-led review includes a short learning review of decisions that did or did not achieve their expected effect. Lessons are recorded in the learning repository (the Learning Hub; Annex G, Module 10); lessons of value to other offices are flagged for regional sharing and presented at the MEC (Annex C, Domain 9).
9. **Clean-up of the 2026 log.** By 31 January 2027, each office reviews its SAM1 2026 decisions: it merges duplicates, closes those completed with evidence and adds the root cause and owner to the rest.

Who does what

WHO Representative	Chairs the monthly review; accountable for the log and follow-through.
MEAL focal point	Maintains the log and tracker; verifies completion before closure.
Programme leads	Own and complete the actions.
Regional Office clusters	Meet the support standard; support offices on escalated actions.
MSC Unit, DPM and MEC	MSC monitors and reports; the DPM oversees the standard and handles escalated issues between MEC sessions; the MEC resolves escalated issues and refers systemic ones to the RPM.

Timeline

When	Milestone
1 Jan 2027	Decision standard and Regional Office support standard apply
31 Jan 2027	2026 decision logs cleaned in all offices
From Q1 2027	Quarterly learning review in every office; quarterly report on support response times to the DPM
SAM1 2027	First monitoring cycle under the standard
MEC 2027	First annual report on follow-through and support

How compliance is measured

Indicator	Baseline	Target
Decisions recording a root cause, owner and deadline	Root cause 0 of 970	100% of new decisions
Decisions overdue	91 of 970 entries (9%) at export	Below 5%
Actions closed with verification evidence	Not yet measured	100%
Support requests acknowledged within 5 and planned within 20 working days	No standard	At least 90% for both

Decision options

Option	What the MEC would adopt	Implications
A Recommended	**As proposed: decision standard, escalation path, learning review and Regional Office support standard**	Closes the loop at every level; clusters must staff the support standard.
B	Decision standard without escalation deadlines	Simpler to introduce, but overdue actions carry no consequence.
C	Regional Office support standard only	Answers the Country Offices' main request; leaves the country loop open.

Resources

Staff time in the clusters to meet the response standard; platform changes to the decision log and action tracker.

The MEC is asked to

Adopt the decision follow-up standard, the escalation path, the quarterly learning review and the Regional Office support standard (option A).

Framework references: Framework Parts III.4, X.4 and XI.2; Annex B, Section B5; Annex C, Domains 8 and 9; Annex E; Annex G, Modules 7, 8 and 10; Annex J (not in this package). Domains: D8 Decision-making; D9 Learning; D10 Accountability.